

Theseus Paragraph Writing

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Why

Theseus normally only write short sentences rather than any type of long form writing. This means the step up to Perseus (or Artemis/Hermes at the start of the year) with the expectation to write a full essay is difficult. By having students write paragraphs frequently, this transition should be easier and also help improve the students writing in general.

When

It will be taught on the same weeks as online essay. However, students will not be submitting anything online.

Upload Location: Essay Books and Lessons → 2 – Paragraph Writing (Theseus)

How

We will teach the “paragraph writing lessons” the same week that other levels do online essay. However, students will not be submitting anything online. Corrections (and possible grading) can be done in class if time permits. Otherwise, just check on students as they are writing and give feedback and corrections during class.

(No set paragraph structure or progression to keep it simple and accessible to new student)

Lesson Flow

These lessons will follow the same flow as the a regular WR lesson with the production being the actual paragraph writing.

1. PLE (Discussion Questions & Useful Vocab based on the set theme)
2. Warm-up
3. Practice activities (made with the paragraph topic in mind)
4. Production – Writing a Paragraph, teacher corrections & rewrites (if time permits)
 - a. N.B. do not provide sentence skeletons for this – the lesson should be helping them to do this themselves!

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Paragraph Topics

It is up to the planner to pick a level appropriate theme and topic question for the students to write about. The lesson will be made with this topic question in mind, but if teachers wish to edit the topic question for their own class, they can.

There are 4 main types of paragraphs we can focus on;

- **Descriptive**
- **Narrative**
- **Expository**
- **Persuasive**

Example:

Theme: Family

Ideas for paragraph question. (ChatGPT might be a good resource for question ideas)

- Describe one of your family members (Descriptive)
- What did you do with your family last weekend? (Narrative)
- Why is family important? (Expository)
- Why is it best to be an only child? (Persuasive)

Depending on the question, pick a useful skill for the practice.

- Describe one of your family members (**Adjectives / Describing people (He is.. /He has../ His..)**)
- What did you do with your family last weekend? (**Past tense / Sequencing words**)
- Why is family important? (**Reasoning / Modals**)
- Why is it best to be an only child? (**Compare & Contrast / Reasoning**)

The practice activities should introduce a skill that students will use in to write their paragraph in the production.

Template

There is a new template for these lessons, you can find it in the elementary lesson template folder on dropbox.

(DYB Choisun Education Group → 4 – Lesson Planning Resources → Lesson Templates)

Please let me know if you have any questions.

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